

such models. The order specifically alludes to models that contain tens of billions of parameters, trained on far-ranging data, which could pose a risk to national security, the economy, public health, or safety. The executive order emphasises eight policy goals on AI—safety and security; privacy protection; equity and civil rights; consumer protection; workforce protection and support; innovation and constructive competition; American leadership in AI; and responsible and effective use of AI by the Federal Government. The report also suggests that the US should attempt to identify, recruit, and retain AI talent, from amongst immigrants and non-immigrants, to build the required expertise and leadership. This has gained some attention in the social media, as it bodes well for Indian tech professionals and STEM students in the US.

The standards, processes, and tests required to enforce this policy will be developed by government agencies using *red-teaming*, a methodology wherein ethical hackers will work with the tech companies to pre-emptively identify and sort out vulnerabilities. The US government also announced the launch of its own AI Safety Institute, under the aegis of its National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST). During the recent summit, Sunak announced that UK's AI Safety Institute will collaborate with AI Safety Institute of the US and with the government of Singapore, another notable AI stronghold.

End of October, the G7 revealed the International Guiding Principles on artificial intelligence and a voluntary Code of Conduct for AI developers. Part of the *Hiroshima AI Process* that began in May this year, these guiding documents will provide actionable guidelines for governments and organisations involved in AI development.



Union Minister Rajeev Chandrasekhar at the AI Safety Summit held in UK in November 2023
(Source: Press Information Bureau)

In October, the United Nations Secretary-General António Guterres announced the creation of a new AI Advisory Body, to build a global scientific consensus on risks and challenges, strengthen international cooperation on AI governance, and enable nations to safely harness the transformative potential of AI.

India takes a balanced view of AI

At the AI Safety Summit, India's Minister of State for Electronics and IT, Rajeev Chandrasekhar, proposed that AI should not be demonised to the extent that it is regulated out of existence. It is a kinetic enabler of India's digital economy and presents a big opportunity for us. At the same time, he acknowledged that proper regulations must be in place to avoid misuse of the technology. He opined that in the past decade, countries across the world, including ours, inadvertently let regulations fall behind innovation, and are now having to contend with the menace of toxicity and misinformation across social media platforms. As AI has the potential to amplify toxicity and weaponisation to the next level, he said that countries

should work together to be ahead, or at least at par with innovation, when it comes to regulating AI.

"The broad areas, which we need to deliberate upon, are work-force disruption by AI, its impact on privacy of individuals, weaponisation and criminalisation of AI, and what must be done to have a global, coordinated action against banned actors, who may create unsafe and untrusted models, that may be available on the dark web and can be misused," he said to the media.

Speaking to the media after the summit, he said that these issues will be carried forward and discussed at the Global Partner for AI (GPAI) Summit that India is chairing in December 2023. He also said that India will strive to create an early regulatory framework for AI, within the next five or six months. Pointing out that innovation is happening at hyper speed, he stressed that countries must address this issue urgently without spending two or three years in intellectual debate.

AI—To be or not to be

Outside Bletchley Park, a group of protestors, under the banner of 'Pause AI,' were seeking a temporary